Unit 1: Different Forms of Communication

Human communication is divided into:-

- Extra personal
- Intrapersonal
- Interpersonal
- Organizational
- Mass and media

EXTRAPERSONAL COMMUNICATION

- **Communication between human beings and non human entities.**
- **Example- A man and his pet.**
- **It requires perfect coordination and understanding between the sender and receiver as one transmits information or responds in sign language only.**



INTRAPERSONAL COMMUNICATION

- **It takes place within an individual.**
- **Example: Message passed by various parts of our body to the brain.**
- **Even while we are communicating with another party our internal dialogue with ourselves continuous- planning, weighing, considering processing information, self-motivation self-determination takes place at intrapersonal level**

INTERPERSONAL COMMUNICATION

- Communication at this level refers to the sharing of information among people.
- It involves a number of considerations, how many people are involved, how close they are to one another physically, how many sensory channels are used and the feedback provided.

- **Interpersonal communication differs from other forms of communication in that there are few participants involved, they are in close physical proximity to each other, many sensory channels are used, and feedback is immediate.**
- **In this, roles of sender and receiver keeps alternate**
- **Direct and immediate feedback is possible.**
- **Can be formal and informal**

- **Interpersonal communication situation depends on a variety of factors**
- **Psychology of participants**
- **Relationship - between the sender and receiver**
- **Circumstances**
- **Surrounding environment**
- **Cultural context**

ORGANIZATIONAL COMMUNICATION

- **In an organization communication takes place at different hierarchical levels.**
- **Large number of employees are involved in several different activities, the Need to communicate effectively becomes greater in an organization.**
- **With a proper networking system communication is possible even without direct contact between employees.**

Organizational communication can be further divided into the following:-

1. Internal - operational - Communication that occurs in the process of operations within an organization.

2. External - operational- Work related communication that an organization has with people outside the organization.

3. Personal - All communication in an organization other than for business or official purposes.

MASS COMMUNICATION

- **Meant for large audiences and requires a medium to transmit information.**
- **Several types of mass media - journal, books, television and newspaper.**
- **Audience or receiver is heterogeneous and anonymous.**
- **Thus the approach is impersonal**

- **Eg.- press interviews, advertisement**
- **More persuasive in nature than any other form.**
- **Oral communication through mass media requires microphone, amplifier.**
- **Written forms - print or visual media**

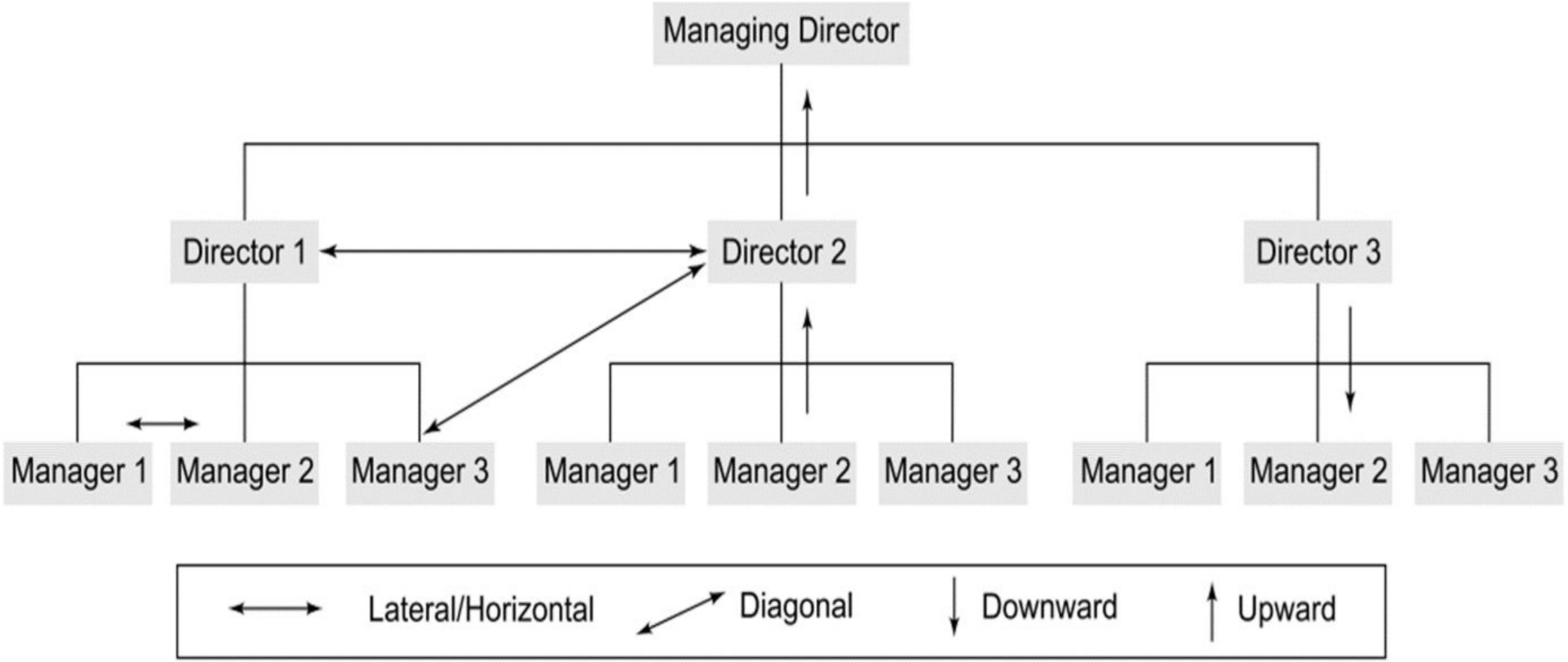
Characteristics of mass communication.

1. Large reach - huge scattered audience.

2. Impersonality - impersonal as participants unknown to each other.

3. Presence of a gatekeeper or mediator - needs additional persons, institution or organization to convey the message from a sender to a receiver. It could be a person or an organized group active in transferring information - newsroom, newspaper office - editor gatekeeper.

FLOW OF COMMUNICATION



- Information flows both formally and informally

  Formal communication can flow in various directions:
- **Vertical Communication- Downward, Upward**
- **Lateral/Horizontal**
- **Diagonal**

- **Vertical communication** consists of communication up and down the organization's chain of command.

a) Downward- from top to bottom- from a manager down the chain of command- when managers inform, instruct, advise or request their subordinates, communication flows in downward direction.

Downward communication can take any form emails, memos, notices, face-to-face conversation, telephonic conversation

b) Upward Communication- from bottom to top-when reports or findings are sent to supervisors. Important for decision making and gathering day to day information Form: reports, statistical analysis

- **Horizontal/Lateral Communication**- takes place among peer groups or hierarchically equivalent employees at the same level.
- Important to facilitate coordination, save time, bridge any communication gap. E.g.-sharing of reports for better ideas.
- **Diagonal Communication/Cross-wise/Radical/Circular**
- Flows in all directions and cuts across the various functions and levels in an organization.
- E.g. Sales manager communicating directly with the vice president (production) of different branches. It is a deviation from the normal chain of communication. It expedites action.